Annotation Guidelines: Google Maps

Introduction and Definitions

In this annotation, we explore a case study of product review summaries from the Google Maps platform. Our data includes 100 restaurants with up to 100 reviews each, plus a short 1-3 sentence summary split into clauses. Your goal is to mark reviews that are relevant for each clause and to mark whether they are supporting, contradicting, or neutral. In addition, you will give a label for factual consistency and relevance as a Likert score from 1 to 5, where higher is better.

The data is given as an Excel sheet, where you mark the relevance of a review to each clause by inputting the number of that clause. Then, for each of the relevant clauses, you mark to its right in the supporting/contradicting field which of these clauses it supports/contradicts.

Annotation Process and Criteria

First, read the summary and the clauses it has been segmented into and start a timer. Go through each of the reviews, while filling out what clauses are relevant and whether each of these clauses supports/contradicts/is neutral for the review. Then, stop the timer and fill out the number of minutes and seconds it has taken. Finally, give the whole summary a Consistency and Relevance score. Details for the annotation are given in the following subsections.

On average, my annotations required ~13 minutes per restaurant, where some could be done in 5 minutes, and the max was about 35 minutes. **To maintain annotation quality, we ask you to complete annotations in several chunks of not more than two hours each**; experience has shown that concentration and subsequently annotation quality decrease afterwards.

Relevance and Support/Contradict/Neutral labels for the Reviews

A review is relevant to a clause if it contains information that could provide evidence for or against the claim expressed by that clause. Among relevant reviews:

- **Supporting**: the review provides evidence in favor of the claim.
- **Contradicting**: the review provides evidence against the claim.
- **Neutral**: the review discusses the same aspect but does not provide evidence either for or against the claim.

For a neutral review, enter the clause number under Relevant, but not under Supporting or Contradicting.

When a review mentions a specific property, mark only the corresponding clause; when it gives a general evaluation of an aspect that encompasses several clauses, mark all clauses representing that general aspect.

Other considerations are:

1. **Multiple Clauses for Single Aspect:** If there are multiple clauses discussing one aspect (e.g., staff being "helpful, nice, and accommodating"), for a specific review mark only the ones that are relevant if they directly mention any of those attributes; otherwise, mark all of them (e.g., if the review said "Good service", mark helpful, nice, and accommodating).
2. **Specific Dishes:** Some clauses discuss a specific dish; mark reviews that discuss this dish as relevant. A review mentioning a specific dish can then support the overall message of the sentence (e.g., it being delicious) or contradict it (e.g., finding it gross).
1. **Hedging with Quantifiers:** Some clauses might include a hedging expression ("Some reviews think A"). During the marking of relevant and contradicting/supporting/neutral reviews, disregard this hedge. I.e., you should still count and tally reviews for the main claim. Do consider the hedge when giving your Consistency and Relevance scores.

Time Field

We ask you to start a timer before you start annotating a restaurant and to stop the timer once you have annotated all the reviews. Fill in the time in the time field in the following format: 13:12, if the annotation has taken 13 minutes and 12 seconds.

Consistency Score:

After reading the summary and annotating all reviews, you will give a Consistency score from **1 to 5, where higher is better**. This should indicate how factually correct the summary is compared to the information mentioned in the reviews. Since the summary summarizes opinions, you can expect some clauses to not be unanimously endorsed by all reviews, which is expected; given this information, still mark whether the summary does its best to summarize the reviews factually.

As a baseline, here are criteria for what constitutes each number:

- 5 **Fully consistent**. The summary's substantive clauses accurately represent the reviews. Any disagreement among individual reviews is compatible with the way the summary characterizes the overall documents.
- 4 **Mostly consistent**. There is a localized inaccuracy, overstatement, or weakly supported claim, but it does not substantially change the summary's overall characterization of the reviews.
- 3 **Partly consistent**. One or more substantial clauses materially mischaracterize the reviews, although a substantial portion of the summary remains accurate.
- 2 **Mostly inconsistent**. Several substantial claims mischaracterize or are unsupported by the reviews, making much of the summary unreliable.
- 1 **Fundamentally inconsistent**. The summary's central characterization of the reviews is unsupported or contradicted by the reviews.

Relevance Score:

After reading the summary and annotating all reviews, you will give a Relevance score from **1 to 5, where higher is better**. This should indicate how much of the relevant information contained in the reviews is shown in the summary. Since the summary summarizes many opinions, you can expect that some information will be left out. Do still mark whether all important information, as much as is possible to contain within such a short summary, has found its way into the summary.

As a baseline, here are criteria for what constitutes each number:

- 5 **Fully relevant:** The summary captures all major information and salient aspects that could reasonably be included given its length.
- 4 **Mostly relevant:** The summary captures nearly all major information and aspects. A small amount of meaningful information may be omitted, but the overall view of the reviews is well represented.

- 3 **Moderately relevant:** The summary captures several important aspects but omits at least one major aspect or enough meaningful information that the representation is noticeably incomplete.
- 2 **Slightly relevant:** The summary captures only a limited subset of the important information. Multiple major aspects are omitted, so the summary gives an incomplete view of the reviews.
- 1 **Not relevant:** The summary captures little or none of the important information in the reviews.

Additional Information

3. **No need to label "Older Reviews" at the bottom:** These have been left in for completeness.
4. **Different Languages:** Some reviews are written in a different language (e.g., Spanish/Chinese); disregard these completely.